

Darko Mesaros
Distinguished Developer Advocate, AWS,

Developers' rising AI slop problem

AWS' Darko Mesaros explains the solution

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"From the world of AI slop we see online, where there's just low-quality content being created — there's also AI slop in software development," says Darko Mesaros, Distinguished Developer Advocate at Amazon Web Services (AWS).

And he even points to some of the tell-tale signs of poorly AI-generated code. "We all know how an AI-developed application looks. It has this look to it," Mesaros points out. Same layout, same gradient, same README file.

"But it's not about the looks, it's also about the quality," which matters, according to Mesaros. It's 2026, and AI has advanced so much that even agents can write code. In this reality, knowing what the code is doing and caring enough to check if the generated code works as intended is going to be increasingly important for developers to master.

It's not a model problem, it's a process problem, and at a select media roundtable in Bengaluru, AWS wants to make the tedious part of coding and software engineering worth doing again.

"How can we enable developers to apply the best practices of software development and use AI to build that good piece of software?," asks Darko Mesaros. The response is Kiro, and the newly launched open-source toolkit, Kiro Crew.

Making AI-enabled coding spec-driven again

Kiro Crew is an open-source workspace with self-learning AI agents that act as autonomous teammates for code development. Not only is it heavily used internally within Amazon, but some Indian startups have started walking down Kiro's spec-driven development path as well. Stock trading platform Dhan, healthcare provider Pristyn Care, and fintech firms Analytics Fox and Glimmertech all utilize Kiro's structured workflows to dramatically accelerate prototyping cycles, according to AWS.

All this because Kiro is aimed to force developers to stop evading the best practice in coding, which is spec-driven development. Why do programmers and code developers bypass this important step? Because it's quite tedious, forcing developers to come up with requirements doc, design doc, task list, and other project blueprints before even a line of code is written. AWS and Mesaros are honest about why developers have evaded spec-driven development.

"Spec-driven development is a practice that developers have been using in software development for a long, long time, but it is one of those things that's incredibly tedious," he said. "You have to create a requirements doc where you explain what a specific feature would do to users. Then you write a design document where you explain which libraries you're going to be using, which frameworks, what's the tech stack. And then you write a bunch of lists of tasks. That's tedious and quite hard. As a developer, I would just write code. But with AI, spec-driven coding becomes the easy part."

That inversion is one of the key features of Kiro Crew, with its emphasis on spec-driven development. Kiro generates all three documents from a single prompt, then holds itself to these guidelines while generating code. "This is a contract between a developer and an agent — in this case Kiro — of what Kiro will be building," Mesaros said. "So you can ensure that what you actually want to build will be built."

Why is this increasingly necessary in code development? Because it helps